Volume A | Manager's Step-by-Step Execution Notebook

This manual guides preparation and proposed future work. It is not an instruction from PSS, a delegation of authority, a regulatory opinion, or proof of a completed validation.

DECISION LIMIT: Before formal appointment and written authority, do not represent PSS, engage banks as PSS, request internal data, issue RFIs, touch live transactions, or approve expenditure.

How to use this notebook

- Read Volume B when you need to find a document; Volume C before editing Excel; Volume D when executing a work procedure.
- Open the original Master Programme Control workbook in 00_Start_Here and create a working COPY under a separate approved workspace after joining. Do not overwrite the source library.
- Choose today's tasks from the primary 48-task notebook below. The newer 32-task Joining Workplan is a consolidation/roll-up, not 32 additional independent jobs.
- Every update needs date, who performed it, authority or purpose, output file ID, contrary evidence, and proposed next action.
- Completion requires evidence and owner review; never tick Done merely because a template exists.

0 Prepare the workspace — before appointment

1. Keep current 18 source packages and their SHA manifests immutable. Make a personal WORKING folder with READ_ME and dated version log; keep confidential PSS data out of it.
2. Use S04/V01 only as a proposed research mandate. Present no PSS letterhead or representation until appointed and authorised.
3. Identify the six blockers from audit A01–A06: authority, bank buyers, real product capability, legal permissions, verified financials and independent assurance.
4. Create a dated claim register: source URL/document ID, claim, evidence category (public/document-backed/proposed), retrieval date and planned refresh.
5. Prepare an access-needs list, redacted questionnaires and synthetic test data only. Do not invite banks or vendors before permission.
6. At each week's end choose three high-priority tasks, open any discrepancy or new source claim as a change request, and preserve the baseline.

1 Gate-by-gate operating sequence

Stage / time	Action and required permission	Output and stop rule
Pre-join	Personal source review and document indexing only	Dated evidence log; no institutional representation.
Days 1–15 (proposed)	Confirm appointment, sponsor, TOR, classification, bank/data outreach rights	Signed scope before PSS system access and official contact.
Days 16–45 (proposed)	Validate internal inventory and licensed read-only evidence, bank pain and current capability	V03/V05 verified logs; no live pilot implied.
Days 46–75 (proposed)	Compare sourcing and bank/PSS economics; cybersecurity/legal review	Updated F02–F05 with certified input and dissent.
Days 76–90 (proposed)	Commission independence and revise F01 options and decision	Signed limited decision, or defer/stop; no capital release by default.

2 Original 48-job notebook: action-by-action instructions

Source: 05_Joining_and_Execution/V05_Notebook/01_Personal_Joining_and_Action_Notebook.docx. Original IDs P01–P18 are personal tasks; they are NOT the similarly named product document P01. Original J01–J30 are institutional jobs. Below is the source task wording and added execution technique.

P01 | Pre-joining | Create a controlled index of all prior PSS A360 documents

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: File index, precedence note

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: Open the Master Programme Control / Package Index; compare the 18 folders and source hash manifest; record any missing or duplicate ID in Audit Findings.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P02 | Pre-joining | Mark S02, S03, V03 as drafts and assign their unresolved evidence needs

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: Assumptions and gap map

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: Open S02 scoring, S03 capability and V03 validation; mark each underlying proposition proposed, verified public or needs review; link the associated Evidence Gate.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P03 | Pre-joining | Refresh PSS public source and new product-claim register

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: URLs, retrieval dates and status labels

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: Open PSS original official publications; capture the precise product name/version, source URL, publication date and scope in Source Refresh; flag changed claims.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P04 | Pre-joining | Reconcile official NBE register with public PSS licence announcements

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: Licence discrepancy question log

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: Compare the NBE operator register with dated PSS statements; list each licence number, claimed activity and unresolved actual legal scope; leave final interpretation for F03 counsel.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P05 | Pre-joining | Review NBE draft NDPS actions without assuming they are law

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: Policy action/uncertainty map

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: Read the NBE draft strategy's status directly; list only proposed QR/MDR incentives and plan actions; exclude draft measures from F04/F05 revenue assumptions.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P06 | Pre-joining | Prepare five-option bank-neutral competitor and counterfactual matrix

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: S02 updated strategic option evidence

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: Open S02 Scoring, Sensitivity and Evidence_Map; document A–E and the BAU benchmark at identical scope; state what evidence would reverse the early ranking.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P07 | Pre-joining | Complete V05 validation plan and metric glossary (no real PSS data)

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: V05 pre-access document

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: Open V05 Data Requests and V05 Metrics Calculator; define numerator, denominator, date range and source for each KPI without entering values or implying a test occurred.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P08 | Pre-joining | Prepare an anonymised/synthetic merchant-cohort sample schema

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: Data definition template; no live data

Source completion / priority: Medium

Task-specific steps: Design synthetic merchant_id, bank_id, source_channel, event_id, received_at, authorisation_state and settlement_reference; prohibit real merchant or bank identifiers.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P09 | Pre-joining | Draft PSS Pay, gateway, switch, POS and 3DS product interview guides

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: Separate product owner questionnaires

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: Use S03/V05 product inventory; draft open-ended questions about deployed versions, customers, controls, API rights and actual operational metrics; map questions to product owner roles.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P10 | Pre-joining | Specify event/status/reconciliation test cases for PSS Operate

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: Test script templates only

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: From P02 States/EventFields and F02 Test_Cases prepare expected evidence for duplicate, reversal, out-of-order, uncertainty and final-settlement states; mark every test unexecuted.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P11 | Pre-joining | Prepare source-linked vendor/partner comparison grid

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: Build–buy–partner framework

Source completion / priority: Medium

Task-specific steps: Open P04 Criteria, Hard Gates and TCO; write a public-source vendor/partner checklist with identical technical/security/exit tests; do not solicit vendors yet.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P12 | Pre-joining | Prepare bank pricing interview questions without suggesting a PSS tariff

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: V03 pricing worksheet draft

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: Read V03 Pricing and ROI and F04 field guide; ask first about current bank costs and decision rights, then an unaided budget ceiling; avoid planting price anchors.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P13 | Pre-joining | Prepare a cost and 36-month forecast input dictionary, no false prices

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: F05 model input specification

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: List CAPEX, onboarding, bank adapter, fixed OPEX, variable cost, FX/tax, discounts and cash timing in F04 Actual Inputs and F05 Inputs; leave monetary cells blank.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P14 | Pre-joining | Draft a service catalogue for Operate, Connect and optional Accept

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: Product requirements hypotheses

Source completion / priority: Medium

Task-specific steps: Map Operate, Connect and conditional Accept against P01 Service Catalogue, persona, bank buyer problem and technical readiness; tag Grow/deferred features explicitly.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P15 | Pre-joining | Create a cyber, privacy and licensing verification checklist

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: Preliminary control taxonomy

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: Use F02 Hard_Gates, F03 Hard Legal Gates and P02 Threats; list exact licence, privacy, PCI/SoftPOS configuration and incident-control proof needed from future owners.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P16 | Pre-joining | Maintain weekly open-question, source and contradiction journal

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: Research journal dated entries

Source completion / priority: Medium

Task-specific steps: At week's end use Decision and Meeting Log plus Source Refresh; note three priorities, source changes, counterevidence and constraints, including why no-build may win.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P17 | Pre-joining | Prepare management induction interview agenda and role entry briefing

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: Meeting script with no assertions

Source completion / priority: High

Task-specific steps: Prepare separate interview agendas for sponsor, CTO, operations, CFO, Legal/CISO and bank relations; keep questions about scope, evidence custodians and approvals central.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

P18 | Pre-joining | Draft Gate 0 feasibility mandate and record missing budget information

Gate: PERSONAL ONLY

Source notebook field: Unapproved management paper

Source completion / priority: Medium

Task-specific steps: Use S04/V01 mandate plus F01 decision brief; request research remit only and explicitly exclude production, customer commitments, supplier awards and capital release.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J01 | Day 1–7 | Confirm appointment, mandate, reporting line, authorised remit

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: CEO / HR

Source completion / priority: Signed role and responsibilities

Task-specific steps (after approval): Get a dated HR appointment/role record; confirm executive reporting, delegated limits and permission to submit personal research for consideration; record all exclusions.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J02 | Day 1–7 | Read ethics, conflict-of-interest and information-security rules

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: HR / Legal

Source completion / priority: Acknowledgements and access conditions

Task-specific steps (after approval): Complete required ethics, conflicts and data-handling induction; record acknowledgements in the approved institutional location; disclose any related-party procurement concerns.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J03 | Day 1–7 | Request named executive sponsor and cross-functional focal points

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: CEO

Source completion / priority: Approved RACI / sponsor confirmation

Task-specific steps (after approval): Ask sponsor to nominate accountable focal persons in technology, operations, finance, risk, cyber, legal and banking relations; record roles, not assumed sign-offs.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J04 | Day 1–7 | Review 2026/27 strategy, annual plans and related approved roadmaps

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Strategy / CEO

Source completion / priority: Alignment and conflicts register

Task-specific steps (after approval): Request current approved strategy, annual plans and technology roadmaps; compare to S01/P01; open change requests for inconsistency rather than asserting strategic fit.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J05 | Day 1–7 | Submit TOR and request a bounded feasibility spending authority

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: CFO / CEO

Source completion / priority: Recorded approval or rejection

Task-specific steps (after approval): Submit S04/V01 TOR via the proper management route; define budget/expiry, stage deliverables, governance and what is explicitly not authorised; log signed response.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J06 | Day 1–7 | Approve data handling plan before accessing product exports

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: CISO / Legal

Source completion / priority: Written access and processing approval

Task-specific steps (after approval): Ask CISO/Legal for data-classification, purpose, retention, masking and least-privilege plan; do not receive extracts until the approved access protocol exists.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J07 | Day 1–7 | Validate which earlier research remains relevant and which is superseded

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: RPB&D / Strategy

Source completion / priority: Document control update

Task-specific steps (after approval): With authorised stakeholders review source freshness, public statement limits and historical last-mile documents; designate confirmed, replaced and disputed claims.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J08 | Day 1–7 | Arrange owner meetings for PSS Pay, switch, POS, gateway, 3DS, operations

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Technology / Product

Source completion / priority: Approved meeting schedule

Task-specific steps (after approval): Schedule individual current-state sessions with actual PSS Pay, switch, POS, gateway, 3DS and operations owners; request demonstrations/evidence within approved scope.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J09 | Day 8–30 | Verify all NBE licences, actual scope and operator responsibilities

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Legal / Compliance

Source completion / priority: Licence map signed by Legal

Task-specific steps (after approval): Have Legal inspect original NBE licence documents, amendments, scope and scheme permissions; map actual PSS activities in F03 Permission Perimeter and flag gaps.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J10 | Day 8–30 | Examine current PCI DSS, scheme and relevant SoftPOS certifications

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: CISO / Compliance

Source completion / priority: In-scope current proof

Task-specific steps (after approval): Have cyber/compliance inspect current certificates and their system/product scope, expiry and assessor; distinguish PCI DSS from separate MPoC or scheme authorisation.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J11 | Day 8–30 | Obtain product inventory and architecture diagrams for authorised review

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: CTO / Product

Source completion / priority: Controlled current-state map

Task-specific steps (after approval): Obtain authorised current diagrams, vendor inventory, actual APIs and service boundaries; update S03/P02 gap map with source IDs and technology owner's review.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J12 | Day 8–30 | Extract aggregated monthly product KPIs with defined periods

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Product / Operations

Source completion / priority: Data owner-approved baseline

Task-specific steps (after approval): Request aggregated monthly transaction and service KPIs with signed metric definitions; enter only approved deidentified inputs in V05 Metrics Calculator and date the period.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J13 | Day 8–30 | Reconcile completed, declined, reversed and uncertain transactions

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Operations / Finance

Source completion / priority: Signed status definition and sample checks

Task-specific steps (after approval): With finance/operations reconcile authorised event outcomes, reversals, duplicates and settlement ledger references; do not call authorisation a settled receipt.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J14 | Day 8–30 | Map merchant onboarding through servicing and disputes

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Acquiring / Operations

Source completion / priority: Process swimlanes with exceptions

Task-specific steps (after approval): Map merchant onboarding, support, complaints, refunds and dispute handoffs with process owners; compare P03 RACI against actual bank/PSS contracts.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J15 | Day 8–30 | Obtain fully loaded costs, supplier fees and shared platform allocations

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Finance / Procurement

Source completion / priority: CFO-reconciled cost baseline

Task-specific steps (after approval): Have CFO cost owner extract fully loaded staffing, support, cyber, DR, shared capacity, bank adapters and supplier fees; populate F04/F05 with traceable units and dates.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J16 | Day 8–30 | Map existing bank contractual SLAs and change rights

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Legal / Business

Source completion / priority: Contract obligations register

Task-specific steps (after approval): Have bank relations and legal review current bank service agreements, SLA remedies, data rights, permitted product modifications and notice periods; do not assume blanket reuse rights.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J17 | Day 8–30 | Assess PSS Trading participation and procurement conflicts

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Procurement / Legal

Source completion / priority: Related-party safeguard note

Task-specific steps (after approval): Ask procurement/legal to assess PSS Trading ownership and related-party interests; use P04 equal criteria, COI declarations, benchmarking and documented recusals.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J18 | Day 31–60 | Seek permission to launch V03 bank discovery

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: CEO / Legal

Source completion / priority: Outreach authority and approved script

Task-specific steps (after approval): Request written bank research/outreach authority, approved target list, confidentiality and consent templates; update V03 QA and Gate before contact.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J19 | Day 31–60 | Conduct 4–6 exploratory bank buyer interviews (planning range)

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: RPB&D

Source completion / priority: Consent and redacted interview records

Task-specific steps (after approval): Run 4–6 authorised exploratory buyer interviews as a planning target (not a statistical claim); retain consent-qualified anonymised notes and negative responses in V03.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J20 | Day 31–60 | Verify economic buyer, purchasing process, sponsor and budget

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Business / Banks

Source completion / priority: Evidence ladder L0–L5 correctly applied

Task-specific steps (after approval): For each bank separate operational champion, decision maker, economic buyer and budget holder; document evidence of budget authority and purchase process in V03 Buyer Evidence.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J21 | Day 31–60 | Test willingness-to-pay for the specific Operate/Connect bundle

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Finance / RPB&D

Source completion / priority: Observed price reactions vs alternatives

Task-specific steps (after approval): Present the specific Operate/Connect outcome rather than hypothetical broad platform; ask unaided fee ceiling and require measured baseline savings, and capture a reject/no budget result.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J22 | Day 31–60 | Conduct target merchant interviews/field observation with consent

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Research

Source completion / priority: Segment findings and disconfirming cases

Task-specific steps (after approval): After research/consent approval, recruit to V04 Quotas; document current payment mix, reconciliation, connectivity and disputes with coded anonymised observation IDs.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J23 | Day 31–60 | Run bounded technical demonstrations in authorised safe environments

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Technology / Risk

Source completion / priority: Replay/reconciliation test evidence

Task-specific steps (after approval): Coordinate change-controlled synthetic or approved data demo in P02/F02; test tenant isolation, reversal, delayed feeds and idempotency; attach defect/retest results.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J24 | Day 31–60 | Obtain vendor alternatives and estimate bank-adapter marginal costs

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Procurement / CTO

Source completion / priority: Build–buy–partner comparison

Task-specific steps (after approval): With procurement approval collect comparable partner/product solutions, adapter marginal effort, vendor exit and recurring fees; update P04 TCO and Hard Gates objectively.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J25 | Day 61–90 | Combine verified PSS and bank unit economics

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Finance / RPB&D

Source completion / priority: Two-sided cost-to-serve model

Task-specific steps (after approval): Reconcile bank ROI from F04 Bank Economics and PSS contribution from F04 PSS Economics; both must be individually positive using justified data and costs.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J26 | Day 61–90 | Stress test 36 months, low usage, delayed bank and cost/FX shocks

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: CFO

Source completion / priority: Traceable sensitivity and cash model

Task-specific steps (after approval): In F05 stress 60-month investment with 36-month operating visibility as appropriate; delay largest bank, remove unapproved revenues, preserve zero-bank OPEX and test FX/cost shocks.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J27 | Day 61–90 | Prepare benefit-sharing, legal/operator and service responsibility model

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Legal / Product

Source completion / priority: Responsibilities signed or unresolved

Task-specific steps (after approval): Present P03 bank/PSS obligations and F03 service permission map to Legal, Finance and Operations; record accepted and disputed remedies, benefit allocation and access rights.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J28 | Day 61–90 | Run independent Risk/CISO/Legal/CFO challenge

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: Control functions

Source completion / priority: Recorded reservations, remedies

Task-specific steps (after approval): Commission authorised independent Risk/CISO/Legal/CFO challenge under F06; demand source traceability, independent model retest and documented dissent, not self-assurance.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J29 | Day 61–90 | Re-rank Options A–E and document selection reversal conditions

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: RPB&D / CEO

Source completion / priority: Updated S02 and dissent register

Task-specific steps (after approval): Use verified F05 option economics and F06 objections to recompare A–E against no-build; document exactly which evidence causes a strategy reversal.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

J30 | Day 61–90 | Submit Gate 1: proceed, modify, extend or stop

Gate: AUTHORISED INSTITUTIONAL WORK ONLY

Source notebook field: CEO / ExCo

Source completion / priority: Recorded decision; no implied pilot go-live

Task-specific steps (after approval): Update F01 and submit a limited Stage/Gate 1 decision: proceed only within evidenced scope, revise, extend research or stop. Record signatories, conditions and no automatic pilot/capital rights.

Close only when: the completion evidence named above exists, a permitted reviewer can locate it, and unresolved contradictions are recorded.

3 First fifteen days — practical meeting order

Day 1–2: HR, sponsor and boundaries

- Confirm appointment and reporting line; request applicable delegations in writing.
- Receive confidentiality, information security and conflicts/related-party guidance.
- Ask whether the existing personal research may be submitted for internal review, and at what classification.

Day 3–5: set up the programme

- Request sponsor and focal persons from CEO/strategy, technology, operations, finance, compliance, risk and legal.
- Propose S04/V01 as a scoped research TOR; identify prohibitions and approval thresholds.
- Have the programme workspace and restricted evidence collection location provisioned by authorised IT/security.

Day 6–10: challenge existing assumptions

- Send a controlled request list for current PSS products, licences, scheme permissions, contracts, operating metrics and budgets.
- Review S03/V05 questions with named product owners; clarify public announcements versus installed systems.
- Ask Legal and bank relationship leads what written permission official interviews require.

Day 11–15: seek a phase decision

- Hold an internal challenge meeting with five strategic alternatives including no-investment.
- Document what was actually approved, denied, conditional or not decided.
- Issue a Stage-0 evidence backlog and a revised 30-day workplan; do not start any wider scope.

4 Fieldwork sequencing: authorised only

Bank buyer research (V03)

1. Use approved invitation, consent and interview guide.
2. Separate sponsor, end-user, financial buyer and budget owner.
3. Capture baseline costs and actual proof of purchasing authority, not general enthusiasm.
4. Score evidence level and negative responses; avoid counting duplicate organisations.
5. Reconcile each bank's value case in F04 before a commercial claim.

Merchant study (V04)

1. Use quotas and approved recruitment; do not substitute convenience interviews for nationally representative data.
2. Observe current tender types, payment confirmation, disputes and connectivity.
3. Use neutral concept-card order and record refusals/missing data.
4. Protect identities; keep raw notes in the approved evidence store.
5. Translate findings into P01 requirements only through a controlled change.

1. Request permission and actual system inventory; never scrape or access without authority.
2. Select approved synthetic/de-identified traces and confirm what they do and do not prove.
3. Differentiate authorisation, reversal, reconciliation, settlement and ledger evidence.
4. Run duplicate/retry, delayed feed, tenant-isolation and disaster-recovery tests under IT change control.
5. Record each tester, trace, output, retest and CISO/CTO review.

5 Weekly review and decision journal

Field	Write this each week
Top three priorities	Only tasks whose authority, owner and inputs are ready.
What changed	New evidenced fact, dated document and consequence for S/P/V/F work.
Contradictions	Evidence that favours PSS Pay, partner-led or no investment.
Pending approval	Sponsor, exact permission, date requested and resulting constraint.
Next gate	Evidence and named reviewer required to move forward.
Stop conditions	Any legal access, security, economics or independence failure.

6 Practice scenario — when a bank buyer says “interesting”

EXAMPLE ONLY (not a real interview): A bank innovation manager says the reconciliation dashboard looks useful. Record this as interest from a non-budget-holding participant, not a committed sponsor or willingness to pay. Arrange a permitted follow-up with the budget owner, verify the actual reconciliation baseline and price ceiling, and record a negative or inconclusive buyer case if the evidence is missing.

7 Practice scenario — internal evidence contradicts proposal

EXAMPLE ONLY: a product owner shows a mature existing PSS function that already provides required exception reporting. Reopen the build-vs-reuse hypothesis, document the exact system/version and controls, quantify incremental benefit and move the option toward BAU/no-build if it has lower cost and risk. Never protect Operate + Connect from disconfirmation.

8 Reusable weekly action sheet — fill after each permitted work week

Review field	Manager entry
Week ending / authority	[YYYY-MM-DD] / personal preparation or approved PSS mandate ID
PSS work permitted this week	[List only delegated tasks; otherwise mark Not authorised]
Top three next actions	[Task IDs and proposed owners]
Evidence obtained	[Source document/trace locator and expiry date]
Evidence that contradicts the thesis	[What would favour PSS Pay, a partner or no-build]
Approval gates / incidents	[Gate ID, reason blocked, reviewer, safe escalation]
Finance or bank evidence status	[Actual verified vs missing; keep private data outside this file]
Decision and next review	[Exact authorised outcome, date and follow-up]